



SHABBOS

In the



CHABAD



HOUSE KITCHEN

PART 1



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Note: This article is the first of two installments. The second installment, to be published in a future issue b'ezras Hashem, will address ovens and other appliances, *hatmanah*, and miscellaneous bishul-related questions. Questions on these subjects can be sent to editor@compassmagazine.org.

DELICIOUS FOOD IS AN IMPORTANT ELEMENT OF ONEG SHABBOS, ALL THE MORE SO FOR SHLUCHIM AND SHLUCHOS, WHO OFTEN PREPARE ELABORATE SHABBOS MEALS FOR MANY GUESTS. MANY MEKURAVIM TESTIFY THAT IT WAS THE SUMPTUOUS DISHES SERVED AT THEIR SHLIACH'S SHABBOS TABLE THAT GAVE THEM THEIR FIRST POSITIVE EXPOSURE TO SHABBOS, AND THROUGH THAT, TO YIDDISHKEIT IN GENERAL.

SOME OF THE MOST COMMON MELACHOS CONCERN FOOD, AND MANY OF THE THIRTY-NINE PRINCIPAL CATEGORIES OF MELACHOS RELATE TO ITS PREPARATION. A NOTABLE EXAMPLE IS THE AV MELACHAH OF BISHUL, WHICH COMPRISES ACTIVITIES CONNECTED WITH THE PREPARATION AND SERVING OF HOT OR WARMED FOOD. THE ART OF PREPARING AND SERVING A TASTY, ATTRACTIVE MEAL WITHOUT PERFORMING THE MELACHAH OF BISHUL AND OTHER FORBIDDEN MELACHOS IS CENTRAL TO THE PROPER ENJOYMENT OF SHABBOS. TO MASTER THIS ART, IT IS NOT ENOUGH JUST TO BE A GREAT COOK; IT IS IMPORTANT TO BE FAMILIAR WITH THE THEORY AND LAWS OF SHABBOS.

Most of the questions discussed in this article relate to one or more of three general topics: bishul, shehiyah, and chazarah. Below please find a general overview of these topics, to assist in understanding the relevant halachic concerns.



BISHUL: One of the thirty-nine forbidden melachos is bishul, cooking. Generically, bishul denotes any process of altering the physical

state of a substance (e.g., food or liquid) through exposure to fire.

Anything that hastens the cooking process is included in the issur of bishul min hatorah. This includes moving a pot closer to the fire,¹ stirring it,² covering it,³ and removing food from it (as that, too, inevitably involves stirring the food).⁴ These activities are forbidden if the food is not fully cooked.

The prohibition against bishul does not only apply when cooking food over or close to a fire. Under certain circumstances, immersing food in a vessel of hot liquid or pouring hot liquid onto food can also cause bishul. This depends on whether the vessel containing the hot liquid is a *kli rishon*, a *kli sheini*, or a *kli shlishi*.

A *kli rishon* is a vessel that was actually on the fire (even after it has been removed), or a vessel with its own heat source, such as an electric urn. A *kli sheini* is a vessel that was not on the fire, into which hot liquid has been poured from

a *kli rishon*. A *kli shlishi* is a vessel into which hot liquid has been poured from a *kli sheini*.



SHEHIYAH: Shehiyah means to leave food on a flame from before Shabbos, to cook or to remain hot

on Shabbos. Min hatorah, this does not constitute bishul, as an act is only considered a melachah if it was carried out by someone on Shabbos, not if it took place on its own. However, Chazal were concerned that if you put food on the fire just before Shabbos, you might later forget that it is Shabbos and raise the flame, thus violating both bishul and mav'ir (kindling a flame). To avoid such a mistake, Chazal enacted certain restrictions as to how and when we may leave a pot on the fire before Shabbos.⁵

CHAZARAH: Chazarah means to return food to the fire on Shabbos (i.e., you took the food off the fire and are now returning it so that it will stay warm). Chazal were concerned that returning food to the fire would appear as if you are cooking on Shabbos. Additionally, if the food cooled



off, you might adjust the fire and violate Shabbos. For these reasons, they enacted certain restrictions as to how and when this

may be done.⁶

Note: Throughout the article, the halachic term “yad soledes bo” is often used. This refers to a temperature above

1. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:24.

2. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:10.

3. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 254:4.

4. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:30.

5. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:1.

6. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:14–15.



110°F/43°C.⁷ When the term “warm” is used, it does not refer to a specific temperature, rather to a measure of heat that allows the food in question to be served as a warm dish.

It is important to note that the goal of this article is to provide general guidelines. It is not intended to provide a comprehensive treatment of the topics discussed, and many scenarios and details were not touched upon. Whenever you have a specific question, a rov should be consulted.

For a thorough treatment of hilchos Shabbos as they apply to the kitchen (including bishul, borer, and more), please purchase the author’s upcoming sefer, *The Light of Shabbos in the Jewish Home: A Handbook for the Shabbos Kitchen*, which will be available in the near future, b’ezer Hashem.

Another important point to remember is that this article discusses the laws of bishul, shehiyah, and chazarah as they apply to Shabbos. On yom tov, different halachos apply.

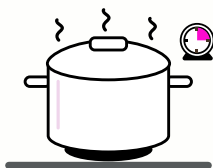
In the merit of our care to keep Shabbos properly, may we merit to see the geulah shleimah immediately!⁸

7. See *Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 4:74, bishul sec. 3.

8. See *Shabbos* 118b. *Likkutei Torah, Vayikra* 41a.

USING A BLECH

Q: IT IS NOT YET SHABBOS, AND MY CHOLENT IS FULLY COOKED. DO I NEED TO LEAVE IT ON A BLECH?



A: No, but the custom is to leave it on a blech.

A blech is only required for food that is raw or has not cooked to the level of *kemaachal ben derusai*⁹ (see

9. *Maachal ben derusai* refers to the minimum amount of cooking a dish would need to be eaten by someone too rushed to cook it completely. There is a machlokes if *kemaachal ben derusai* is one-third done or one-half done. When it comes to leaving food on the stove, we are machmir and require it to be cooked halfway to allow placing it on the stove without a blech. However, be-shaas hadechak, if the food is one-third cooked and you don’t have a blech (or something which can be used in place of a blech—see p. 32), you may leave it on the fire (*Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 253:13).

According to some opinions, the basis for measuring is the normal cooking time. In other words, the food is cooked *kemaachal ben derusai* if it has been cooking for one-half of its normal cooking time. Other authorities object that this is not an accurate measurement, since food cooks more slowly at the beginning, and faster towards the end. According to their view, the food should be physically checked, and this is

note) before shekiah. If all the food in the pot has reached that level before shekiah (and certainly if it is fully cooked), we are not concerned that you will be tempted to turn up the flame, so no blech is needed.¹⁰

However, the universal custom is to use a blech even if the food is fully cooked.¹¹

Q: IF I AM USING A BLECH, DO I NEED TO MAKE SURE THE CHOLENT IS FULLY COOKED BEFORE SHABBOS?

A: No. However, even with a blech, it is recommended to only leave fully-cooked pots on the stove.

The reason for this is that if you leave partially-cooked food on the stove (even on a blech), you must be careful not to move the pot, stir it, or remove the lid until it is fully cooked. Doing any of these activities involves serious shaalos,¹² and

the opinion we follow (see *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 253:16. *Kaf Hachaim* 253:28). Since this is difficult to ascertain, make sure the food is certainly more than halfway done before leaving it on an open flame.

10. *Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 253:1.

11. This way, if you decide to return the pot to the stovetop on Shabbos, you will be allowed to do so (see p. 34). Additionally, the blech will serve as a reminder that it is Shabbos, preventing someone from turning off the flame by mistake.

12. Moving a pot of semi-cooked food closer to the fire constitutes bishul (*Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 318:24), as does stirring the pot



it is best to avoid them by making sure all the food in the pot is fully cooked before Shabbos.

Q: MAY I ADJUST THE FLAME AFTER PLACING THE BLECH ON THE STOVE?

A: Lechat'chilah, the flame should be adjusted to its desired setting before placing the blech on the stove.¹³ However, if the flame was adjusted afterward, the food is permitted.¹⁴

Q: WHEN USING A BLECH, MUST THE KNOBS OF THE STOVE BE COVERED AS WELL?

A: It is best to cover the knobs as well.¹⁵ (Some blechs are bent down in front so as to cover the knobs.) However, if the knobs were not covered before Shabbos, the blech still fulfills its function.

Covering the knobs without covering the flame is not enough.¹⁶

(ibid., 318:10) or replacing the lid (ibid., 254:4).

13. The reason is that such an act contradicts the purpose of the blech, to serve as a reminder not to adjust the flame (see *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, *birurim* 1:20. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 8:15).

14. *Shulchan Shlomo* 253:5. *Shulchan Hamevu'ar* 253, *pischei halachah* 7.

15. *Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 1:93.

16. *Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 1:93.

Q: I DON'T HAVE A BLECH. WHAT SHOULD I DO?

A: You may improvise with a few layers of tinfoil¹⁷ or a baking pan (if this can be done safely). If using a baking pan, turn it upside down, so it will be clear that it is being used as a blech and not for its regular function.

Q: I LEFT A POT OF COOKED FOOD ON AN OPEN FLAME BEFORE SHABBOS. MAY I COVER THE FLAME WITH A BLECH ON SHABBOS (FOR SAFETY REASONS, OR TO ALLOW RETURNING THE POT TO THE STOVE)?

A: Yes, provided that: (1) the food is warm and fully cooked; (2) there is no grease on the blech; (3) the blech will not become red-hot even directly over the fire; and (4) you are careful not to extinguish the fire when covering it with the blech.¹⁸

Q: MAY I MOVE A POT ON THE BLECH CLOSER TO THE FIRE?

A: This depends on where on the blech the pot is found, and where you want to move it.¹⁹

The blech can be divided into four areas (see chart below on this page):

AREA A: The area of the blech directly over the flame.

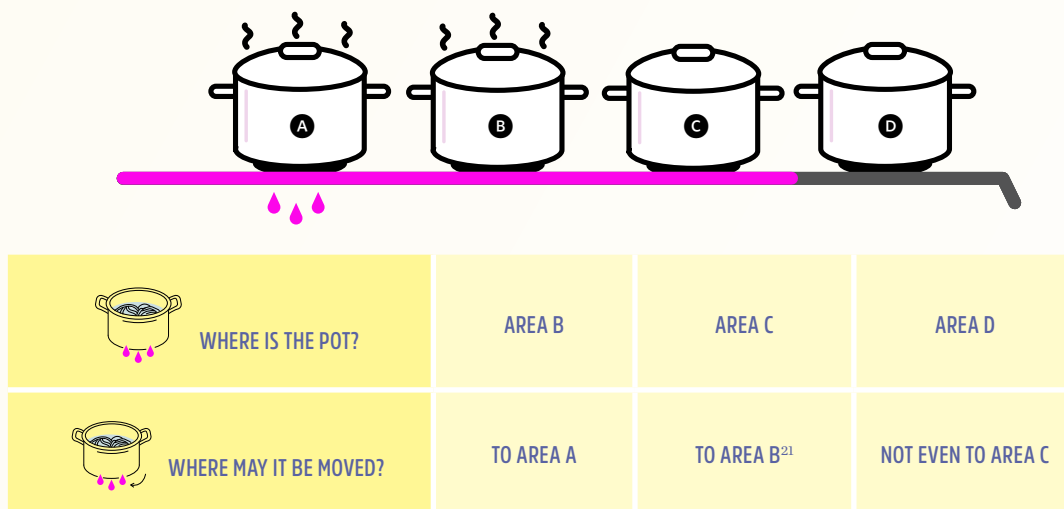
AREA B: The area of the blech adjacent to the flame, where the pot is still hot.

AREA C: The area of the blech that is farther from the flame, where the blech itself is yad soledes bo and the food in the pot is warm but not hot.

AREA D: The area of the blech that is yet farther from the flame, where the blech itself is not yad soledes bo, and the food in the pot is still warm.²⁰

19. See *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 259:2. *Ibid.*, *kovetz halachos hashechichos* (printed after *siman* 259), par. 14. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 10:17–18.

20. If the blech is small or the flame is large, typically the entire blech will be yad soledes bo. Usually, only with a large blech over a small flame will the edge of the blech not be yad soledes bo.



21. The pot may not be moved to Area A even later, once the food inside becomes hot.

In all cases, the pot may only be moved if the food inside is warm (i.e., still warm enough to be served as a warm dish) and is presently fully cooked.

It is always permitted to move a pot from a warmer place to a cooler one. You may then return it to its previous place, following the guidelines in the above chart.

Q: MAY I LIFT THE COVER OF A POT ON THE BLECH TO TAKE A LOOK AT ITS CONTENTS?²²

A: If (some of) the contents of the pot might not be fully cooked, do not lift the cover, as replacing it constitutes bishul.²³

If all the contents of the pot are fully cooked, you may lift the cover and then replace it. If the pot is directly over the flame, move it away so that it is not directly over the flame before replacing the cover.²⁴

Q: THE POT OF CHOLENT ON THE BLECH BECAME VERY DRY. MAY I ADD HOT WATER?

A: Yes, provided that the following conditions are met:

- Both the water and cholent are fully cooked and hot, or at least still warm.²⁵
- The pot is not directly over the fire.²⁶
- The water is poured directly from a kli rishon into the pot.²⁷

If these criteria are met, there is no issue of bishul. Indeed, with a pareve cholent, these are the only precautions necessary. However, with a fleishig cholent, there is another problem involved: the steam rising from the cholent may cause the kettle or urn to become fleishig.

To avoid this issue, follow these directions:

22. A video shiur addressing the next three questions is available here: <https://video.merkos302.com/node/7237>

23. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 254:4.

24. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 5:16.

25. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:9.

26. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:30.

27. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:14.



IF POURING FROM A KETTLE

1. Move the pot to the part of the blech that is not directly over the flame.
2. Lift the lid and wait a few seconds, letting the steam rise.
3. Bring the kettle to the pot. Do not hold the kettle directly over the pot; instead, hold the spout off to the side.
4. Pour hot water from the kettle, holding the kettle higher than usual.
5. Pull the kettle back quickly (so the steam from the cholent will not rise and hit the kettle).
6. Cover the pot and return it to its original place on the blech.



IF POURING FROM AN URN

1. Remove the pot from the fire, having in mind to return it.
2. Lift the lid and wait a few seconds, letting the steam rise.
3. Carry the pot to the urn. (Note: Do not let go of the pot, so you will be allowed to return it to the stove—see below on this page).
4. Pour water from the urn from higher than usual and in short spurts, each time making sure the steam of the cholent does not hit the urn.
5. Replace the lid on the pot.
6. Replace the pot on the blech.

Q: WHAT SHOULD I DO IF I CANNOT BRING THE POT TO THE URN OR THE KETTLE TO THE POT (DUE TO WEIGHT, DISTANCE, ETC.)?

A: In such a case, some authorities permit pouring hot water from the kettle or urn into a cup (i.e., a kli sheini) and then into the cholent. However, others disagree.²⁸

Here are two other solutions, which

28. See *Shabbos Kahalachah* 9:23.



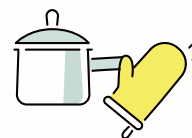
are better from a halachic standpoint:

- Take a clean, dry ladle that was not used with fleishigs for twenty-four hours and immerse it in the hot water long enough for it to reach the temperature of the



water. Then, pour from the ladle into the pot.

- Pour from the urn or kettle into the inverted lid of the cholent pot and from there into the cholent. Clean any trace of gravy or food from the lid before using it for this purpose.



Q: HOW SHOULD I HOLD A POT IF I WANT TO RETURN IT TO THE BLECH ON SHABBOS?

A: When taking a pot off the stove, do not let go of the pot.²⁹

Some authorities say that you should hold the pot in the air or rest it on the edge of the table or counter, so that by holding onto the pot you are keeping it from falling.³⁰ According to others, you may place the pot on the table or counter, as long as you do not let go of it.³¹ (In this case, some say it is better to put something between the pot and the countertop that is not usually used for this purpose—e.g., a towel, as opposed to a trivet.³²) Preferably the first opinion should be followed.

If the pot is very heavy, you may put something on the countertop (that is not usually used for this purpose), put the pot down, and simply hold onto it. Alternatively, you may move the pot to Area C of the blech (see p. 32), hold onto it, serve from there, and then push it back to where it was over the fire.³³

29. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:14.

30. *Pirush Hamishnayos LehaRambam*, Shabbos, beg. of ch. 3. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 9:15. *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 253:24:10.

31. *Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 4:74, bishul sec.

33. *Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah* (new ed.), 1:20.

32. *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 253:24:11.

33. *Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 4:74, bishul sec. 11–12. *Pnei Shabbos* 253:24:12.



Q: I LET GO OF THE POT BY MISTAKE. MAY I RETURN IT TO THE STOVE?

A: Yes.



Bedi'eved, if the pot slipped from your hand or if you let go of it by mistake (e.g., you removed the cholent pot instead of the soup pot and let go of it), contemporary authorities permit replacing the pot, provided there is a blech in place and the food is fully cooked and warm.³⁴

Q: IN ADDITION TO HOLDING ONTO THE POT, ARE THERE ANY OTHER CONDITIONS THAT MUST BE MET TO ALLOW RETURNING THE POT TO THE STOVE?

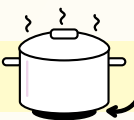
A: Yes. The following conditions must also be met:³⁵



The pot must have been on the stove when Shabbos came in.



The food must be fully cooked and hot or warm (i.e., still warm enough to be served as a warm dish).



The pot must be replaced on the blech, and not on an open flame.³⁶



The food must not have been transferred to another pot while off the stove.



When you removed the pot, you must have intended to replace it.

34. See *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 253:25-4. *Shulchan Shlomo* 253:20. *Shabbos Kahalchah* 9:11.

35. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:14, 18-19.

36. This is one of the reasons a blech should be used even if the food is fully cooked before Shabbos (see fn. 11).

Q: THE FLAME UNDER MY BLECH WENT OUT. WHAT SHOULD I DO?

A: Turn off the gas as quickly as possible, to prevent a fire chas veshalom.³⁷ Due to the danger involved, this should be done even if rotating the dial will cause the fire to ignite (as is the case in certain stove models). If possible, however, turn the dial quickly so the fire will not ignite.

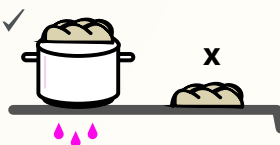
If doing so will not result in a delay, ask a goy to turn off the gas. If there is no goy available, ask (lehavdil) a child beneath the age of chinuch. If this, too, is not possible, try to rotate the dial ke'le'achar yad (e.g., with your elbow). However, if the only available option is to turn off the gas yourself directly, you must certainly do so.

The pot (or pots) may be transferred to another blech, as long as the food is fully cooked and still warm.³⁸ However, it may not be wrapped in a towel or blanket.³⁹ If no other blech is available, transfer the contents of the pot to another container and then wrap it in a towel or blanket.⁴⁰

Q: MAY I WARM UP COLD CHALLAH, MEAT, CHICKEN, OR KUGEL ON THE BLECH?

A: Yes, provided the following guidelines are followed:

1. The food may not be placed directly on the blech. Instead, it should be placed next to the blech or on top of a pot on the blech.⁴¹



37. *Igros Moshe*, *Orach Chaim* 4:74, *bishul* sec. 39.

38. *Igros Moshe*, *Orach Chaim* 4:74, *bishul* sec.

38. *Pnei Shabbos*, vol. 1, 253:25:6. *Shabbos Kahalchah* 9:12.

39. This is because hatmanah is forbidden on Shabbos even with a *davar she'eino mosif hevel*.

40. This is because hatmanah is permitted with a *kli sheini* (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch*, end of *hilchos shehiyah vehatmanah bektzarah*—printed after *siman* 259).

41. *Kuntres Acharon* to *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 253:26.

2. If the food may exude liquid, fat, or oil, it may only be reheated if the exuded liquid will not be able to reach yad soledes bo.⁴²
3. Additionally, such food may only be reheated if the amount of exuded liquid is negligible (e.g., the dish contains a minimal amount of fat to begin with, or it has a crust or the like that will absorb most of the melting liquid).

If the food contains a large quantity of fat or oil and most of it will not be absorbed, we are machmir not to reheat it.⁴³ However, in case of need, you may do so.⁴⁴

In practical terms, if you remove challah or kugel from the freezer and it has ice chips, shake them off as best as possible. If a small amount remains, the food may still be reheated (by placing it near the blech or on a pot on the blech), provided the remaining ice particles will not reach yad soledes bo.

Q: ARE THERE ANY CASES WHEN FOOD ON A BLECH MAY NOT BE EATEN ON SHABBOS (DUE TO A MELACHAH DONE TO IT)?

A: If the food was not fully cooked and you accidentally pushed it closer to the fire, stirred it, or covered it, it may not be eaten until motzo'ei Shabbos.⁴⁵

42. According to the Alter Rebbe in his *Sidur (Hilchasa Rabsa Leshabbata)*, if the food exudes even a small amount of liquid and the liquid reaches yad soledes bo, it will constitute bishul. This is because bishul applies to previously-cooked, cold liquid (see fn. 61). Therefore, reheating roast meat, boiled chicken, kugel, etc. (if even the slightest amount of liquid might be exuded) is only permitted if the liquid will not be able to reach yad soledes bo.

43. Due to the issur of molid, "creating" a new entity.

44. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:25-27.

45. See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:1.

SERVING HOT FOOD



Q: MAY I STIR A POT OF HOT SOUP OR CHOLENT?

A: No.

If the food is not fully cooked, stirring will accelerate the cooking process and is forbidden, even if the pot is off the blech.⁴⁶ Even if the food is fully cooked and was removed from the fire, it is better to refrain from stirring it.⁴⁷

Q: MAY SOUP BE SERVED FROM A POT THAT IS STILL ON THE FIRE?

A: The pot should be removed from the fire before serving from it.⁴⁸ However, if food was served from a pot while on the fire, it may be eaten.

Q: MAY I RETURN THE LADLE TO THE POT AFTER SERVING?



A: It may only be returned if the moisture on the ladle is still warm or has been wiped off.

After ladling food from a hot pot, the ladle will be coated with a layer of food. If the ladle is then put down outside of the pot, the food adhering to the ladle will rapidly cool off. The food on the ladle will thus get re-cooked when the ladle is returned to the pot.⁴⁹ To avoid this problem, leave the ladle in the pot between servings. Alternatively, dry the ladle before dipping it back into the pot.⁵⁰

Q: MAY I REPLACE THE COVER ON THE POT AFTER SERVING?

A: The same applies to pot covers: If the condensation on the underside of the lid is still warm, it may be replaced. If not, dry the lid before covering the pot.⁵¹

Q: WHAT MAY BE ADDED TO SOUP THAT IS IN A KLI SHEINI?

A: See chart below:

	 YAD SOLEDES BO (110°F/43°C) ⁵²	 NOT YAD SOLEDES BO
UNCOOKED FOOD (WITH THE EXCEPTION OF LIQUIDS AND SPICES)	X ⁵³	✓
UNCOOKED LIQUID ⁵⁴	✓	✓
SPICES (EXCEPT SALT)	✓	✓
SALT	BETTER NOT TO ⁵⁵	✓
DRY, COOKED NOODLES	✓ ⁵⁶	✓
CHALLAH, MATZAH, MANDLEN (SOUP NUTS)	X ⁵⁷	✓

52. This column of the chart deals with a kli sheini that is yad soledes bo but not boiling (212°F/100°C). If it is boiling, it has the ability to cook (even in a kli shlishi), and it is therefore forbidden to put any type of uncooked food or liquid into it (see *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:20. *Ketzos Hashulchan* 125, fn. 31, s.v. *Vehinei kasav*).

53. If the liquid is not boiling but is yad soledes bo, it still has the ability to cook certain foods. Since we do not know for sure which foods can be cooked in a kli sheini, we avoid the problem by not putting any uncooked food into a kli sheini containing liquid that is yad soledes bo. The only exceptions are spices and liquids, which may be put into such a kli sheini (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:11-12).

54. For the halachos that apply to previously cooked liquid, see fn. 61.

55. There is a machlokes as to whether salt may be placed in a kli sheini that is yad soledes bo. The Rema writes that one who refrains from doing so is praiseworthy (*Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim* 318:9, cited in *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:17).

56. There is no issue in re-cooking food that was previously cooked (e.g., cooked noodles), as *ein bishul achar bishul*. Therefore, such food may be put into any kli sheini (even one containing boiling liquid), provided the food is completely dry (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:11).

57. Regarding food that was previously baked

46. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:10.

47. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:30.

48. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:30.

49. See fn. 61 that bishul applies to previously-cooked, cold liquid.

50. *Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah* (new ed.) 1:40 and 1:54, quoting R. Shlomo Zalman Auerbach.

51. *Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah* (new ed.), ch. 1, fn. 108.



Q: IF I AM SERVING SOUP WITH A LADLE, DOES THAT MAKE THE BOWL HAVE THE DIN OF A KLI SHLISHI?

A: It depends if the ladle was left in the pot or not.

The chart above applies to a kli sheini in general. In the case of soup that was transferred to a bowl, there is an added factor—the fact that the soup was served using a ladle.

A ladle which was left in the pot is considered a kli rishon.⁵⁸ Therefore, the bowl into which soup has been ladled is a kli sheini, and all the above guidelines must be followed. (Alternatively, you may transfer the soup to another bowl, thus creating a kli shlishi, and then add the desired items.)

However, if the ladle was only dipped into the pot long enough to serve the soup, the ladle is considered a kli sheini,⁵⁹ and the bowl is a kli shlishi. Therefore, you may place any type of food into the soup.⁶⁰

(See p. 35 that if leaving the ladle outside of the pot between servings, the ladle should be dried before dipping it back into the pot.)

Q: MAY I TAKE A SECOND HELPING OF SOUP IF THERE IS MOISTURE IN THE BOWL FROM THE FIRST SERVING?

A: If the remaining liquid is warm enough to be served as a warm dish (even if it is not yad soledes bo), you may add more hot soup to the bowl. If the remnants have completely cooled off, dry the bowl before adding more soup.⁶¹

(as opposed to cooked), e.g., challah, matzah, or mandlen (soup nuts), there is a machlokes as to whether bishul applies (*yesh bishul achar afiyah* or *ein bishul achar afiyah*). In practice, we are machmir not to put such items into a kli sheini that is yad soledes bo (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:12).

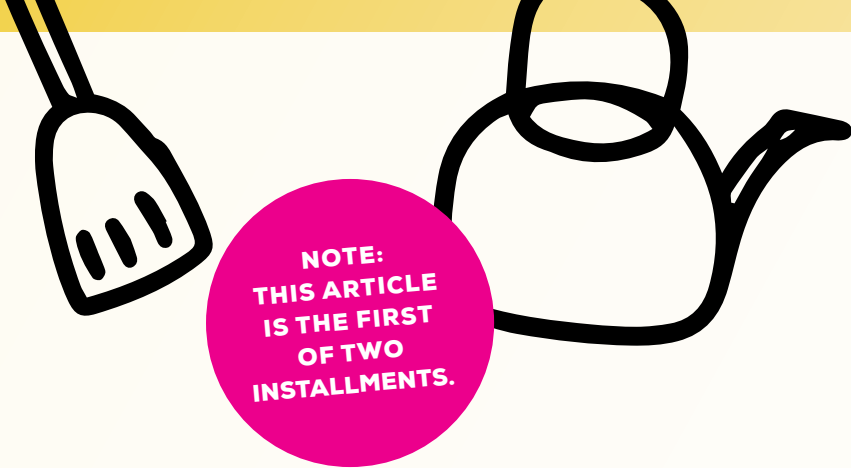
If the mandlen were not baked but deep-fried in oil, they may be added to a hot kli sheini, following the rule that *ein bishul achar bishul*. However, most mandlen today are baked and not deep-fried.

58. *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 451:28.

59. See *Shu"t Tzemach Tzedek*, *Yoreh Deiah* 74. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 1:52-54.

60. See *Mishnah Berurah* 318:45. *Shu"t Minchas Yitzchak* 5:127:3.

61. There is a machlokes whether bishul applies to previously cooked liquid. The general custom is to allow reheating of liquids as long as the item is still



Q: MAY I ADD SPICES OR FLAVORING TO HOT CHOLENT, MEAT, OR CHICKEN THAT HAS BEEN SERVED ON A PLATE (I.E., A KLI SHEINI)?

A: See chart below:

	 YAD SOLEDES BO		 NOT YAD SOLEDES BO (WHETHER WITH OR WITHOUT SAUCE OR GRAVY)
	WITH SAUCE OR GRAVY	WITHOUT SAUCE OR GRAVY	
SPICES AND FLAVORING OTHER THAN SALT (E.G., GARLIC, MAYONNAISE, OIL, MARGARINE)	✓ ⁶²	X ⁶³	✓
SALT	BETTER NOT TO ⁶⁴	X	✓

Some opinions allow adding ketchup or other previously cooked condiments to dry, hot food in a kli sheini.⁶⁵ However, it is preferable to wait until it is below yad soledes. 

warm enough to be served as a warm dish. However, if the liquid has cooled off to the extent that it can no longer be served as a warm dish, it is forbidden to reheat it (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:9).

62. Solid food bathing in sauce or gravy has the same status as liquid, and the halachah will therefore depend on the "degree" of the vessels involved (kli rishon, kli sheini, etc.), just as when dealing with liquid foods (See *Ketzos Hashulchan* 124 fn. 39). Therefore, if the cholent, meat, or chicken contains a generous amount of sauce or gravy and is in a kli sheini, you may add spices or flavoring (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 318:12). (The status of cholent, meat, or chicken with just a little sauce or gravy is questionable.)

63. According to many Poskim, with solid food that does not have gravy or sauce, no distinction is made between kli rishon, kli sheini, and so on. No matter how many times the food has been transferred, the food is viewed as a kli rishon (so long as it stays above yad soledes bo), because solid food retains heat longer than a liquid. The Alter Rebbe's opinion on this matter is unclear (see *Ketzos Hashulchan* 124 fn. 39. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 1:56. *Dover Sholom* 318:31). Therefore, salt and other spices or flavoring should not be added.

64. See fn. 55.

65. See *Igros Moshe*, *Orach Chaim* 4:74, *bishul* sec. 5. *Shabbos Kahalachah* 1:62, *biurim* 33.